

# Matthias Florian Sahli


**Postdoctoral Researcher**

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## SUMMARY


I am a postdoctoral researcher at the Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH) Business School, and was previously a researcher at the World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO) of the United Nations. I received my PhD in Economics from the University of Neuchâtel in 2023. My research focuses on the economics of intellectual property, innovation, digitization, sustainability and the creative industries. The goal of my work is to provide solid empirical evidence that supports current policy discussions. To do this, I invest considerable time and creativity in developing new datasets and conducting rigorous econometric analyses.


## ACADEMIC POSITIONS

2024 – present — **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Business School, Bern, Switzerland
Postdoctoral Researcher

## EDUCATION

2025 – 2026 — **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH)** · Bern, Switzerland
Certificate in Higher Education Teaching (Hochschuldidaktik)

2019 – 2023 — **University of Neuchâtel** · Neuchâtel, Switzerland
PhD in Economics

2016 – 2019 — **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
MSc in Economics

2012 – 2016 — **University of Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
BSc in Economics, minor in Political Sciences

2006 – 2011 — **Gymnasium Hofwil & Schule für Gestaltung Bern** · Münchenbuchsee, Switzerland
Matura; talent promotion class in fine arts

### VISITING

2020 — **Copenhagen Business School (CBS)** · Copenhagen, Denmark
Visiting student

2020 — **University of Southern Denmark (SDU)** · Odense, Denmark
Visiting student

2017 — **École Polytechnique Fédérale de Lausanne (EPFL)** · Lausanne, Switzerland
Visiting student

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

2019 – 2024 — **World Intellectual Property Organization (WIPO), United Nations** · Department for Economics and Data Analytics, Geneva, Switzerland
Economist and researcher — PhD Research Fellow (2019–2023), then Postdoctoral Research Fellow (2023–2024)

2017 – 2019 — **Swiss Federal Institute of Intellectual Property (IPI)** · Bern, Switzerland
Economist, Office of the Chief Economist — internship (2017–2018), then Junior Economist (2018–2019)

2013 – 2019 — **Velokurier Bern** · Bern, Switzerland
Bike messenger; member of the cooperative (passive member since)

2011 – 2012 **Stiftung RGZ** · Zurich, Switzerland
Community service, school for people with multiple disabilities

## RESEARCH

| 20 | 77 | 4 | 6 |
|---|---|---|---|
| publications & papers | citations | h-index | peer-reviewed venues |

*Source: Google Scholar, retrieved 2026-11-09.*

### PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

- **Digital Reuse and Online Availability of Visual Artworks**
  M. Sahli, A. Cuntz & P. J. Heald · *Information Economics and Policy* · 2026 · 11 citations
- **Does the Digitalization of the Book Industry Reduce Its Environmental Impact?**
  M. Sahli, J. Bieser et al. · *Cleaner and Responsible Consumption* · 2026 · 1 citation
- **Evaluating the Sustainability of National Libraries: A Life Cycle Sustainability Assessment**
  J. Chenoweth, J. Bieser, M. Day, N. Ilott, M Lin, J. Love, M. Martens, R. Murphy, M Nepfer, M. Pennock, U. Pottgiesser, M. Sahli, O. Sievi, and J. Suckling · *Accepted at npj Heritage Science* · 2026
- **Is There a Premium for Legacy Artists? The Death Effect in Exhibition Shows and Auction Transactions**
  M. Sahli & A. Cuntz · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2025 · 4 citations
- **Sustainability in Context: An Evidence-based (Digital) Preservation Lifecycle Investigation**
  M. Pennock, M. Sahli & J. Chenoweth · *iPRES 2025, Wellington* · 2025 · 2 citations
- **Million Dollar Baby — A Primer on Film Finance Practices in the U.S. Movie Industry**
  A. Cuntz, A. Muscarnera, P. C. Oguguo & M. Sahli · *Industry & Innovation* · 2024 · 15 citations
- **Intermediary Liability and Trade in Follow-on Innovation**
  A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *Journal of Cultural Economics* · 2023 · 21 citations

### UNDER REVIEW

- **From Digitization to Diffusion: Evidence on the Economic Value of Open Cultural Heritage in the Generative AI** R&R AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
  M. Sahli, J. Bieser, J. Chenoweth, J. Suckling, J. Love, E. Lin, M. Martens, M. Pennock & U. Pottgiesser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Gender Gaps in Museum Exhibitions and Art Auctions: Evidence from Linked Exhibition and Auction Records** UNDER REVIEW AT JOURNAL OF CULTURAL ECONOMICS
  L. J. Noll & M. Sahli · *ACEI Working Paper Series* · 2026 · 3 citations
- **Open by Design: Open Distribution as a Strategic Choice for Cultural Organizations** UNDER REVIEW AT PUBLIC MONEY & MANAGEMENT
  M. Sahli, E. Bertacchini & J. Bieser · *Working paper* · 2026
- **Elvis' Ghost or Digital Replica? Publicity Rights and Integrated IP Strategy** UNDER REVIEW AT STRATEGIC MANAGEMENT JOURNAL
  A. Cuntz, B. Lutes & M. Sahli · *WIPO Economic Working Paper No. 89* · 2025 · 1 citation

### BOOK CHAPTERS, DISSERTATION & OTHER OUTPUT

- **Decarbonizing Supply Chains: Systematically Managing and Reducing Supply Chain Emissions**
  M Senn, M Sahli, J Bieser · *Berner Fachhochschule, Wirtschaft, 2026* · 2026
- **Elvis' ghost, Jordan's Airness, and the new economics of publicity rights**
  B Lutes, A Cuntz, M Sahli · *https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/elvis-ghost-jordans-airness-and-new-economics ..., 2025* · 2025
- **Empirical Essays on the Economics of Creative Industries** PHD DISSERTATION
  M. Sahli · *University of Neuchâtel* · 2023
- **VoxEU column: How the US film industry mitigates financial risk**
  A Cuntz, A Muscarnera, PC Oguguo, M Sahli · *https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/how-us-film-industry-mitigates-financial-risk, 2023* · 2023
- **Risky Trade? Appropriation Art, Copyright and Secondary Market Effects**
  A Cuntz, M Sahli · *https://culturaleconomics.org/risky-trade-appropriation-art-copyright-and ..., 2023* · 2023
- **The Covid-19 Impact on Artistic Income: Evidence from Germany** BOOK CHAPTER
  A. Cuntz & M. Sahli · *CEPR Press & Covid Economics 82* · 2022 · 1 citation

- **Pommerehne Prize, President's Prize and Young Researchers Workshop Best Paper Award**
  F Etro, D Noonan · *Journal of Cultural Economics 45 (3), 513-514, 2021* · 2021
- **VoxEU column: Appropriation artists: Follow-on innovation versus intermediary liability and trade**
  A Cuntz, M Sahli · *https://cepr.org/voxeu/columns/appropriation-artists-follow-innovation ..., 2021* · 2021
- **Digitalisierung und Umwelt**
  J Bieser, M Sahli · —

## TEACHING

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| 2026 – | **HES-SO — Haute École de Gestion Genève**<br>· Economics of Innovation (guest lecturer) |
| 2025 – | **Bern University of Applied Sciences (BFH), Business School**<br>· Entrepreneurial Law (Master), lecturer and module coordination ★ 5.5 / 6<br>· Digitalrecht (Bachelor), lecturer ★ 5.25 / 6<br>· Data Literacy (continuing education), lecturer<br>· Lecture Series SDG1 (Bachelor), lecturer |
| 2025 | **EPFL, College of Management**<br>· MGT-404 Management of Intellectual Property (Master) ★ 1.24 / 4<br>1 = best possible score |
| ongoing | **Supervision of Student Theses**<br>· Supervision of bachelor's and master's theses, practice projects and applied R&D projects |

## SELECTED TALKS

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| 11/2026 | DINAcon — Conference for Digital Sustainability, Kongresszentrum Bern · Bern, Switzerland SCHEDULED |
| 11/2026 | Swiss National Library · Bern, Switzerland SCHEDULED |
| 10/2026 | DUN — Dachverband der Urheber- und Nachbarrechtsnutzer · Switzerland |
| 06/2026 | European Academy of Management Annual Conference (EURAM 2026) · Kristiansand, Norway |
| 06/2025 | International Conference on Cultural Economics (ACEI) · Rotterdam, Netherlands (3 papers) |
| 06/2025 | IP-Network BFH — IP and Economics · Bern, Switzerland |
| 04/2025 | BFH sounding board meeting · Bern, Switzerland |
| 06/2024 | DRUID24 · Nice, France |
| 03/2024 | EPFL STIP Research Retreat · Crans-Montana, Switzerland |
| 02/2024 | Cultural Economics Online Seminars — symposium on causal inference in cultural economics · online (video recording on YouTube) |
| 10/2023 | Unlocking value from digital heritage collections — invited panellist (Wikimedia Italy) · Turin, Italy |
| 07/2023 | SERCI Annual Congress · Bournemouth, UK |
| 03/2023 | Digital Economy Workshop, University of Lausanne · Lausanne, Switzerland |
| 11/2022 | WIPO internal research seminar · Geneva, Switzerland |
| 09/2022 | SERCI Annual Congress, University of Colorado Law School · Boulder, USA |
| 09/2022 | European Policy for Intellectual Property Conference (EPIP), University of Cambridge · Cambridge, UK |
| 09/2022 | Tenth European Workshop on Applied Cultural Economics · Turin, Italy (participant) |
| 07/2022 | Urban Creativity Conference, University of Lisbon · Lisbon, Portugal |
| 06/2022 | Munich Summer Institute (MSI) · Munich, Germany |
| 04/2022 | Cultural Economics Online Seminar · online (video recording on YouTube) |
| 04/2022 | WIPO internal online seminar · online |
| 09/2021 | EPIP PhD Workshop · Madrid, Spain |
| 07/2021 | ACEI Young Researchers Workshop, 21st Conference on Cultural Economics · Lille, France |
| 06/2021 | IRENE PhD Meeting, University of Neuchâtel · Neuchâtel, Switzerland |
| 03/2021 | IP & Innovation PhD Virtual Seminar, University of Lausanne · online |
| 12/2020 | Research Workshop, Copenhagen Business School · Copenhagen, Denmark |
| 11/2020 | PhD Seminar Series, University of Southern Denmark · Odense, Denmark |

09/2020 PhD Seminar Series, ETH Zurich (Law and Economics, Prof. S. Bechtold) · Zurich, Switzerland

06/2020 First Econ Online Seminar, WIPO · Geneva, Switzerland

10/2018 Reinventing the world — the power of Industry 4.0 · Belgrade, Serbia

## OUTREACH, MEDIA COVERAGE & OTHER OUTPUT

### PODCASTS

2023 Do Market Players React to Court Decisions Impacting Art? · Art Law Podcast (Spotify)

### COLUMNS

09/2023 The effect of copyright on the digitisation and availability of visual artworks · VoxEU / CEPR

### BLOG COVERAGE

10/2023 Life after Death: The Effects of an Artist's Death on Exhibitions and Auctions · EconomistTalkArt (ACEI)

### REPORTS & NOTES

2021 COVID-19 impact on artistic income — WIPO Economic Research Working Paper No. 65 · WIPO

2020 WIPO Creative Economy Note 2020/21 · WIPO

### PRESS

2026 Digitalisierung und Umwelt - Warum das Zusammenspiel von digitaler und physischer Infrastruktur entscheidend ist · Bulletin.ch; Bieser J., Sahli M.

## ORGANIZED CONFERENCES & SEMINARS

06/2026 ICT4S 2026 International Conference, Bern University of Applied Sciences
Organizing Committee

11/2022 An Industry Practitioners Event on Intellectual Property Rights and U.S. Movie Finance, WIPO Geneva
Co-organizer

## POLICY WORK

2018 Value of IP in the New Economy. WTO TRIPS submission (IP/C/W/648) · Co-author

2017 Intellectual Property & Innovation: Inclusive Innovation and MSME Trade. WTO TRIPS submission (IP/C/W/635) · Co-author

### CITED IN POLICY PUBLICATIONS

2026 Crato, N., Di Novi, C. & Meroni, E. C., "Harnessing Administrative Data for Policy Evaluation in Labour, Education and Health Economics", in Data-Driven Learning in the EU, Springer
Edited volume, European Commission Joint Research Centre · cites A. Cuntz & M. Sahli (2022), The Covid-19 Impact on Artistic Income: Evidence from Germany

## GRANTS & AWARDS

2026 Swisscom study — "From Data to Action: Do Digital GHG Management Tools Drive Real-World Emission Reductions?" (CHF 32,409)

2021 Best Paper Award, Young Researchers Workshop, 21st International Conference on Cultural Economics, Lille (USD 500)

2020 Travel grant for the study visit at Copenhagen Business School — Commission de Recherche FNS / Fonds des Donations, University of Neuchâtel

## ACADEMIC SERVICE

Peer review Journal of Cultural Economics (3) · European Journal of Law and Economics (1) · Humanities and Social Sciences Communications (2) · Socio-Economic Review (1) · Applied Economics (1) · Economics of Governance (1) · DRUID · EURAM · Public Money & Management (1)

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| Memberships | Society for Economic Research on Copyright Issues (2022–2024) · European Policy for Intellectual Property (2022–2024) · Association for Cultural Economics International (until 2027) |

## DOCTORAL COURSES

Workshop and lecture series in law and economics — ETH Zurich and the Universities of Lucerne, St. Gallen and Zurich (Prof. E. Ash, Prof. S. Bechtold, Prof. G. Hertig, Prof. S. Lüchinger, Prof. A. Stremitzer), Spring 2021

Obtaining data from the internet: data crawling for research in business and economics — University of Zurich (Prof. C. Peukert, Prof. J. Claussen), Spring 2021

## RESEARCH INTERESTS & SKILLS

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|---|---|
| Interests | Intellectual property · economics of innovation · industrial organization · economic policy · applied econometrics · creative industries · art markets · sustainability · digitization |
| Languages | Swiss German (native) · German · English · French |
| Software | Stata · R · Python (basics) · LaTeX · web crawling |

## REFERENCES

**Prof. Dr. Gaétan de Rassenfosse**
EPFL

**Prof. Dr. Jan Bieser**
Bern University of Applied Sciences

**Dr. Carsten Fink**
Chief Economist, WIPO

**Dr. Alexander Cuntz**
Senior Economist, WIPO

*E-mail addresses available on request.*